Facilitation on Conflict Management

An interactive workshop on diagnosing conflict styles and choosing the right response under pressure.

Facilitated by

ALI & JOY

STEP 1 · GREETING

Greeting: 5min

STRATEGIC GOAL

Get attention, read the room, and spark genuine interest before the real work starts.

THE RISK

Skip this, and you get no clue about the room, no engagement, no early buy-in.



THE EXERCISE

One-Word Check-In

“In one word, how do you feel walking into a conflict?”

- 1. Participants each write their word on a piece of paper.
- 2. They stand up and walk their word to a shared board at the front.
- 3. The wall of words becomes the visual opener for the session.

STEP 2 · ENTRY & ORIENTATION

Entry

Clarify the topic before anyone is asked to reflect on it.

Set the Agenda & North Star Goal

State plainly what the next hour covers and the one outcome that defines success. This is the promise you'll be held to at Debrief.

Floor-Line Positioning

Tape a line across the floor. Participants place themselves on it based on how they typically face — or avoid — conflict, then cluster by outcome tendency.

THE SPECTRUM ON THE FLOOR



I AVOID CONFLICT — I FACE CONFLICT HEAD-ON

Clusters that form along this line become a live, physical preview of the conflict styles covered next in Theory — no slide needed yet.

STEP 3 · THEORY

The Conflict Grid

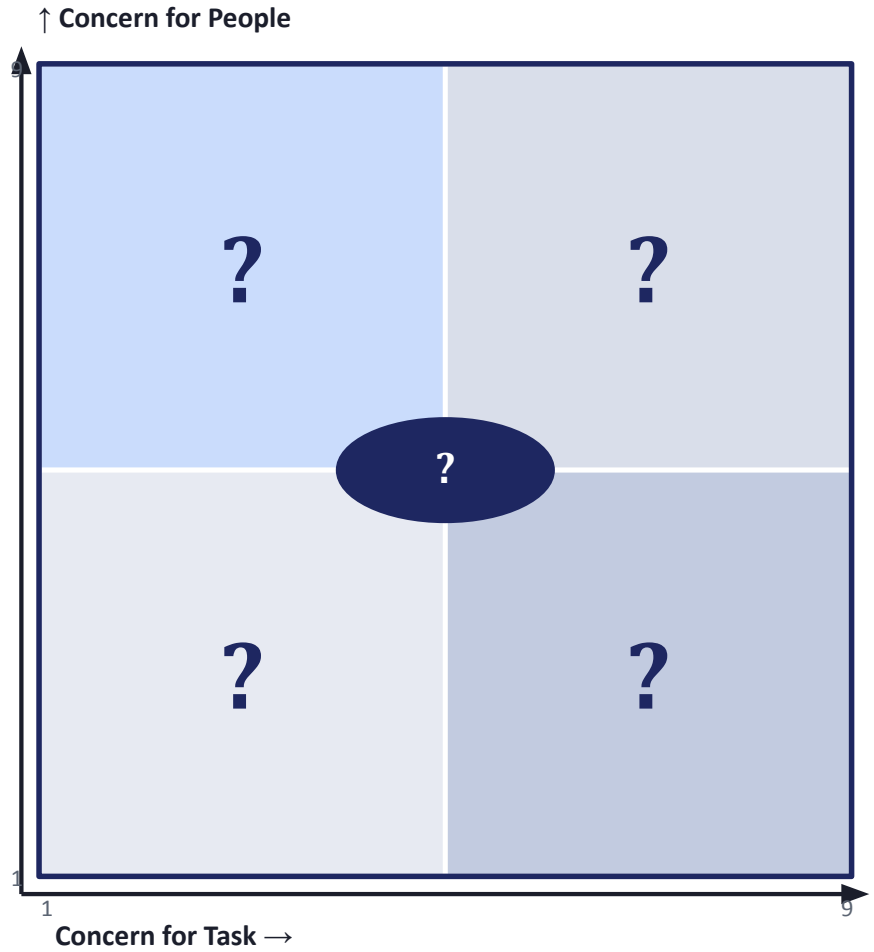
Blake & Mouton's model — before we name the five styles, guess where they sit.

Five ways to handle friction

Every conflict response trades off two things: how much you care about the task, and how much you care about the relationship.

ASK THE ROOM

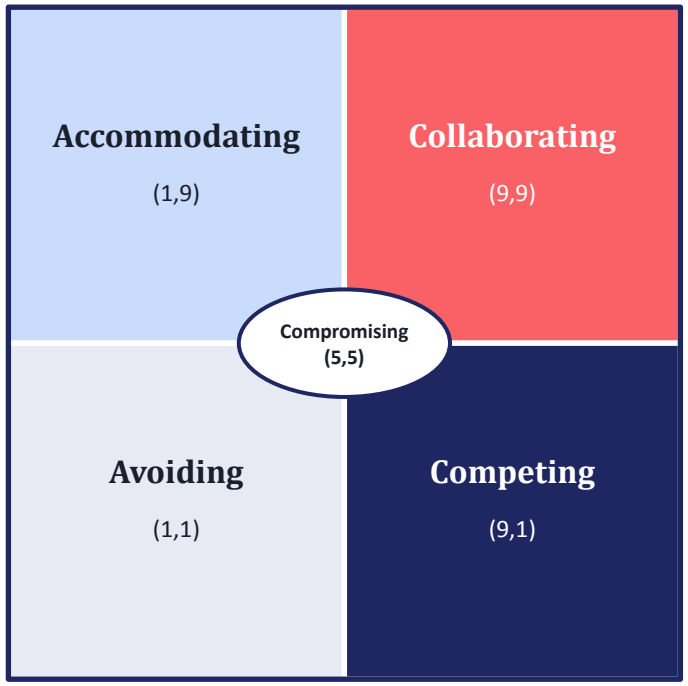
"What would you call the style that lives in each corner?"



STEP 3 · THEORY

The Five Conflict Styles

↑ Concern for People



Concern for Task →

Collaborating (9,9)

Work together for a true win-win that satisfies both goals and preserves the relationship.

Accommodating (1,9)

Yield to the other side to protect harmony — a lose-win outcome.

Competing (9,1)

Use power or authority to force your agenda through — win-lose.

Compromising (5,5)

Split the difference so each side gains and gives up something.

Avoiding (1,1)

Withdraw from the friction, leaving the issue unresolved — lose-lose.

STEP 4 · INTERACTIVE CORE

The Trio Consultation: 20min

Peer coaching in groups of three, applying the grid to a real conflict.



Case Owner

Prepare on case, take role of 1st Person



Case Owner

Prepare on case, take role of 2nd Person



Observer

Watches silently, tracks time, then gives feedback on the coaching dynamic.

15 MINUTES

Hand each trio a short, real business case. The Case Owner may swap in their own conflict instead. If time allows, run a second round and rotate roles.

STEP 5 · DEBRIEF

Debrief: Rose, Bud, Thorn

A fast structured reflection before the room loses the thread.

R

Rose

A HIGHLIGHT

What moment in your trio worked well?
Which conflict style showed up at its best?

B

Bud

AN EMERGING OPPORTUNITY

What's one thing you'd like to try differently
the next time a real conflict comes up?

T

Thorn

A CHALLENGE

What felt hard, awkward, or unresolved?

FACILITATOR TIP

Run this in trios first (2 min), then pull 2–3 Thorns to the whole room — don't let every trio report out.

STEP 6 · CLOSING TAKEAWAY

Leave With Something Real

Lock in commitment and take a final pulse of the room.



Dear Future Me

“Dear Future Me, one thing I want to remember from today is…”

Participants write this note by hand and keep it — no sharing required.



One-Word Close

Each participant shares a single word describing how they feel leaving the room — a rapid, honest pulse check on the group's energy.

OPTIONAL ADD-ON — FIST TO FIVE

If you need a firmer read on buy-in, ask participants to hold up 0–5 fingers showing their commitment to applying a new style before they walk out.

MILESTONE DELIVERABLE 2 OF 3

The Operational Cheat Sheet



The North Star Goal

By the end of the hour, every participant can name their default conflict style on the grid and choose a more effective one for a real situation they're facing.



The Cut Option

If we're short on time, we drop the second role-swap round of the Trio Consultation and move straight into Debrief with one round only.



Instruction Check

< 2-MINUTE SCRIPT

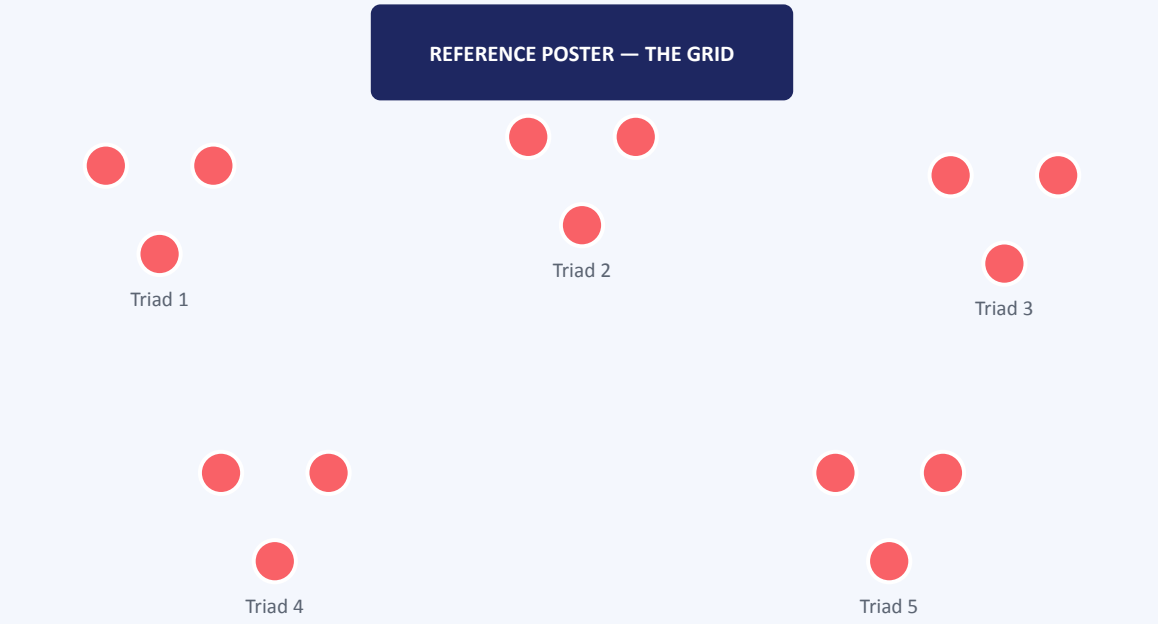
“Here's how this works. I'll split you into groups of three. In each trio, you'll take one role: two Case Owner (having the conflict) or Observer. The Case Owners explains their part in a real conflict for five minutes. In the final three minutes, the Observer shares what they noticed about the conflicting dynamic, not the content. Fifteen minutes total — watch your table's timer.”

MILESTONE DELIVERABLE 3 OF 3

Room & Material Blueprint

Set up for the Trio Consultation — ready before doors open Sunday morning.

ROOM LAYOUT — TOP VIEW



Space triads 4–5 ft apart so coaching conversations stay private. Keep the front third of the room open for the poster and Entry floor-line exercise.

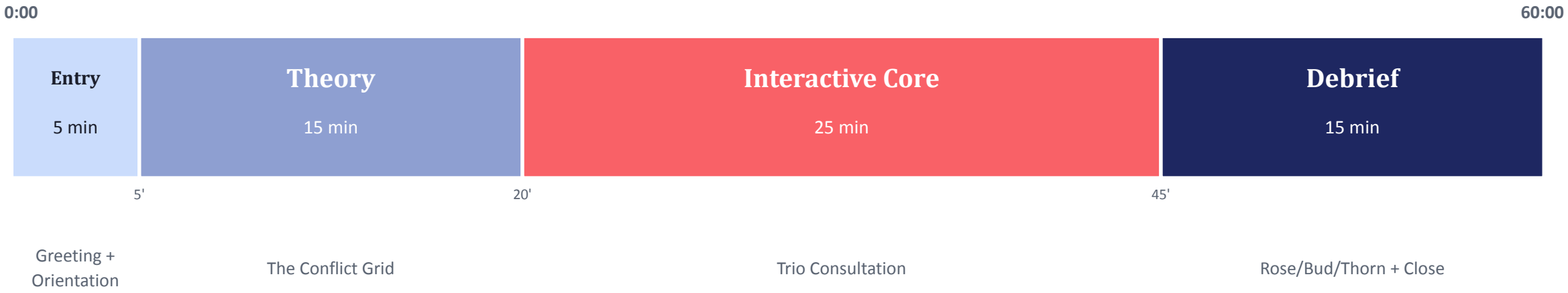
MATERIALS CHECKLIST

- Business-case handouts — 1 set per triad
- Role cards: Case Owner / Consultant / Observer
- Visible timer or stopwatch per triad
- Flipchart poster of the Conflict Grid
- Blank paper + pens for the Observer's notes
- Floor tape for the Entry spectrum line
- Board + markers for the Greeting check-in
- Index cards for “Dear Future Me” notes

THE SANDWICH TIMELINE

60 Minutes, Minute by Minute

Every segment earns its place, or it gets cut first — see the Cheat Sheet, next.



WHY “SANDWICH”?

Light, fast bread (Entry) on either end; the dense filling (Theory + Interactive Core) does the real work in the middle. Debrief closes the loop the Entry opened.